



## FLINTLOCK RIFLES, CARBINES, AND BLUNDERBUSSES (1761–1830)

During the 18th century, rifled weapons first made their mark on the battlefield. Military rifles were not only accurate, they also allowed soldiers to fire at long-range targets. However, muskets and carbines, all smoothbore weapons at the time, continued to be the most common firearms in most armies, with rifles still being supplied only to elite sharpshooter companies. Blunderbusses, which fired lead shot that spread out over a wide area in just a short distance, provided an excellent weapon for self-defense. In Europe, these were often carried by guards on mail coaches.



### ▲ ENGLISH FLINTLOCK RIFLE

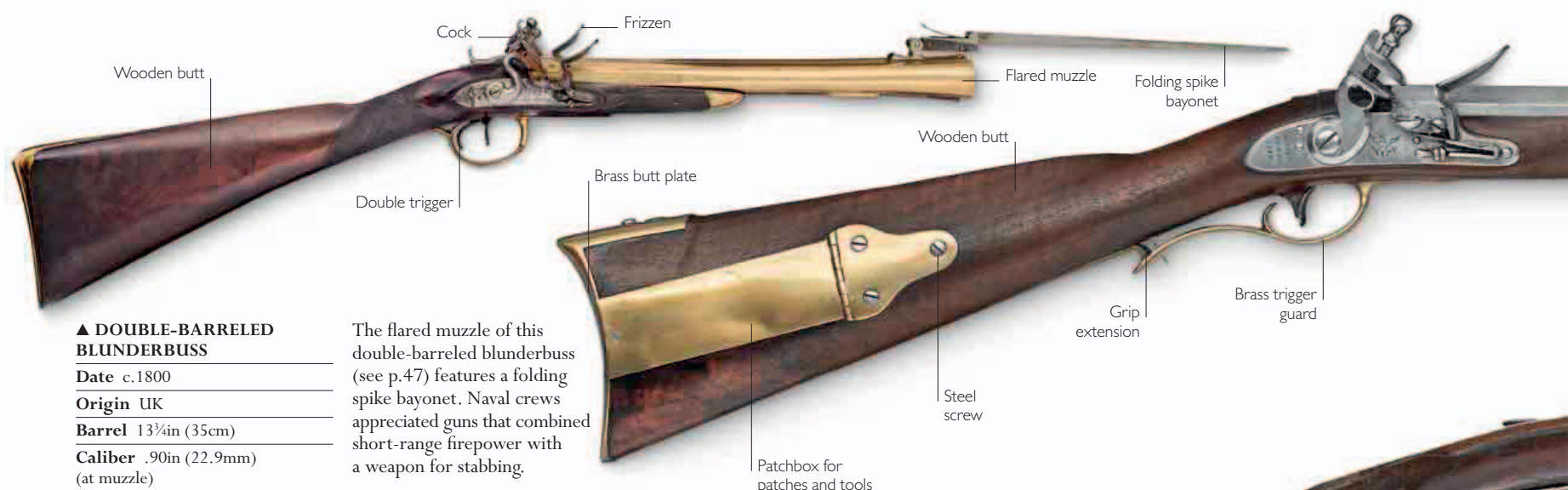
Date 1791

Origin England

Barrel 32in (81cm)

Caliber .68in (17.3mm)

Innovative London gunsmith Henry Nock made several volley guns (see p.83) for the Royal Navy and numbered Ezekiel Baker (see pp.60–61) among his apprentices. Nock designed this flintlock rifle—possibly an officer's private purchase—with nine-groove rifling.



### ▲ DOUBLE-BARRELED BLUNDERBUSS

Date c.1800

Origin UK

Barrel 13¼in (35cm)

Caliber .90in (22.9mm)  
(at muzzle)

The flared muzzle of this double-barreled blunderbuss (see p.47) features a folding spike bayonet. Naval crews appreciated guns that combined short-range firepower with a weapon for stabbing.



### ▲ CLEMMES FLINTLOCK BLUNDERBUSS

Date 1810

Origin UK

Barrel 12½in (31.75cm)

Caliber 1.2in (30.5mm) (at muzzle)

This blunderbuss had a short effective range of around 30 yards (27m), depending on the type of lead shot used. A few larger-diameter shot would have greater penetrating power, while a large number of small shot would cover a target area more completely, leaving fewer chances of missing the target.